The Seve & Olly

11

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Hushed expectations descend on our group at three specific times every tour, namely those moments when the Captains come to announce their pairings for the following day's golf. The Round I pairings are perhaps the most anticipated as they come at the end of the OC when everyone is truly revved up to the max for the first day's golf; they are also the moment when the Captains first show their strategic hand.

Over the years we have seen differing reactions to the Round I pairings, ranging from some Dogs being fast asleep to others being overly excited – the excitement perhaps never better demonstrated than in this clip of the final pairings in advance of Round I of BDT 2019!



The Seve & Olly Award!

There have been some aggressive fourballs over time, maybe none more so than the "Bite & Swipe" crew of BT, DT, Hursty and Ravo who drank their bodyweight around the Great White course in Miami. Yet the fourball of Marshy, Hursty, Ravo and Langers on BDT 2022 would likely have given them a good run for their money!



▶ **Watch:** BDT 2019 Day I Pairings!

When it comes to Round II, the Captains have an element of form to go off which makes those pairings intriguing as everyone knows by this stage which Dogs it would be best to avoid. It is also the time when the Captains decide whether or not to roll the dice on a particular pairing and maybe even stick with a Round I pairing.

In fact, the same pairing has only gone out in Rounds I and II on relatively rare occasions and this statistic is somewhat skewed by Round II of BDT 2005. Here Captain Robbo of the Retrievers decided to roll out exactly the same four pairings he had used for Round I, simply reversing the order, flummoxing and irritating the Bloodhounds in equal measure which ultimately led to an 11-5 victory!



▶ **Watch:** The Drinking Fourball!

The Retrievers tried the same trick again on BDT 2008 but this time the Bloodhounds were better prepared and secured a convincing 10-6 victory.

Other repeat pairings on the same tour have been Paddy & Picko, who went out together in Rounds I and II of BDT 2004, whilst for the Bloodhounds DT & Buzz and Charlie & Boggy both paired together twice on BDT 2007.

On BDT 2008 there were several repeat pairings on both sides, with the Bloodhounds twice rolling out their pairs of DT & Buzz and Little & Langrish and the Retrievers putting out twice their combinations of Marshy & Knoxy and Robbo & Picko.

Most recently, just last year DT & Boysie went out first together for the Bloodhounds twice on BDT 2025, losing on both occasions.

Over the years a few "Hail Mary" pairings have been thrown out on the course and after securing a valuable half in Round I Knoxy & Adam T were paired twice on BDT 2017, only to lose in Round II. In a couple of the ultimate "Hail Mary" pairings, Rufus and Knoxy secured a half against Ash & Charlie, whilst Rufus & Adam T won 5&4 vs Charlie & Glenn on BDT 2024. Just last year another "Hail Mary" pairing in Adam T and Bean secured an absolutely crucial point for the Retrievers in the final match of Round II!

Some pairings have simply rolled off the tongue, such as "Coxy and Knoxy" on BDTs 2011 and 2012, or the "Two Ollie Gs" who played together on BDT 2012. With other pairings it has just seemed that they were simply destined to be together, like Brian & Ken.

Of course, the Bloodhounds have fielded numerous RANGA pairings together with varying degrees of success and, who knows, we may see some more RANGAs hitting the course together with a bucketload of sunscreen in their buggy to repel the Scottsdale heat.

The pair who has played the most times for the Bloodhounds is Ash & Charlie who have played together 10 times, securing 5.5 points, closely followed by Buzz & DT who have played eight and won four points.

For the Retrievers, Marshy & Knoxy have 2.5 points from their nine matches together, followed by Hursty & Oli G with 4.5 points from 8 matches.

Maybe the most anticipated pairing in tour history has been BT and Oli G, who led out the Retrievers for Round II of BDT 2013, but to everyone's surprise they succumbed to a 3&2 humbling at the hands of Charlie & Ravo, the only Bloodhounds to win a point for their team that day!

Pairings we may not see in Scottsdale are Boysie & Little for the Bloodhounds, who have secured precisely 0 points from their six matches together, whilst for the Retrievers only a brave captain would pair Paddy & Hursty who have 0 points from their four matches.



▶ **Watch:** BDT 2020 – The Chuckle Brothers Are Paired!

Only once have a pair of brothers been paired together, namely the Chuckle Brothers at The Belfry on BDT 2020 – see the footage below.

Clearly the Captains' selection of their fourballs is a crucial factor in their team's performance and so to honour and recognise the importance of a fourball performance, we introduced a new trophy on BDT 2019, the Seve & Olly, in honour of the greatest pairing in Ryder Cup history – 12 points from 15 matches is simply ridiculous!!!

Here are the winners of the Seve & Olly since its inception and each Captain will be hoping one of his pairings is added to the roster for BDT 2026.



BDT 2019 – Buzz & Langrish Beat Paddy & Robbo 1UP in Round I



BDT 2020 – Paddy & Robbo Beat Adam T & Buzz 6&5 in Round II



BDT 2021 – BT & Gav Beat Ash & Langers 3UP in Round II





BDT 2022 – Charlie & Ash Beat BT & Gav 4&3 in Round I



BDT 2023 – Knoxy & Rufus Halved With Ash & Charlie in Round I



BDT 2024 – Adam T & Rufus Beat Charlie & Glenn 5&4 in Round I





BDT 2025 – Adam T & Bean Beat Langers & Tom 2&1 in Round II

The main focus of this memory has been the Fourball pairings, but the Captains' order for the Singles is also a crucial factor. It has become something of an unwritten rule in recent years that the Taylor brothers, both playing off scratch, go out in Match I; but note that this is not a formal tour rule and so anything could happen in Scottsdale...





Captain Boyes on BDT 2015 and Captain Robbo on BDT 2005

History shows that the Singles draw is incredibly important in determining the final outcome of any tour; the same number of points is on offer for Round III as the combined points available over Rounds I and II and thus anything can happen if the draw falls correctly for your side.

Coming back to BDT 2026, we are already looking forward with much anticipation to the moment when Boysie and Robbo take to their feet to announce their Round I pairings at the end of the Opening Ceremony!!!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

In the end Boysie had to withdraw before the tour, so Ash and Robbo captained in Scottsdale. Bean & Harbo won the 2026 Seve & Olly.





Bean & Harbo – The 2026 Seve & Olly Champs